

**AGA CLINICAL PRACTICE GUIDELINE ON PHARMACOLOGICAL
INTERVENTIONS FOR MANAGEMENT OF OBESITY**

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Committee

ONLINE SUPPLEMENT

Supplementary Table 1. Problem, Intervention, Comparison, Outcome (PICO)

question for this Guideline

Problem	Adults with BMI $\geq 30 \text{ kg/m}^2$, or $\geq 27 \text{ kg/m}^2$ and weight-related complications, who have had an inadequate response to lifestyle interventions
Intervention	FDA-approved medications to treat obesity
Comparison	Lifestyle interventions alone
Outcome	<u>Benefits:</u> ✓ % Total Body Weight loss (%TBWL) ✓ $\geq 5\%$ Total Body Weight loss ✓ $\geq 10\%$ Total Body Weight loss <u>Harms:</u> ✓ Treatment discontinuation due to adverse events ✓ Serious Adverse Events <u>Minimal important difference</u> Smallest change in the outcome that would be identified as clinically important was set at -3% TBWL between groups

Abbreviations: Total Body Weight loss (TBWL)

Supplementary Table 2: Serious adverse events from studies, the FDA and contraindications for Semaglutide 2.4 mg

Contraindications ^a	Serious Adverse Reactions FDA ^b	Selected Serious Adverse Reactions original studies' definitions
1. Pregnancy 2. Personal or family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma or in patients with Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia syndrome type 2 2. Known hypersensitivity to semaglutide or any of the excipients in Semaglutide.	1. 131 cases reported (examples: nausea, vomiting, impaired gastric emptying, cholelithiasis, GERD, constipation, thyroid neoplasia, dyspepsia, hypoglycemia, diarrhea, abdominal pain, electrolyte abnormalities/dehydration, LFT abnormality, renal impairment) ^c	1. Wilding 2021: Abdominal pain: I: 3/1306 vs C: 0/655 Constipation: 1/1306 vs 0/655 Diarrhea: 1/1306 vs 0/655 Nausea: 1/1306 vs 0/655 Vomiting: 4/1306 vs 0/655 Pancreatitis: 2/1306 vs 0/655 Vertigo: 3/1306 vs 0/655 Cholelithiasis: 12/1306 vs 1/655 Cholecystitis 4/1306 vs 0/655 Acute MI: 2/1306 vs 1/655 Gastroenteritis: 5/1306 vs 0/655 SI: 1/1306 vs 0/655

a. Product labeling

b. FDA definition: An adverse event when the patient outcome is death, life-threatening, hospitalization, disability or permanent damage, congenital anomaly/birth defect, development of drug dependence or drug abuse (FDA Adverse Event Reporting System Database). See full list on public database.

c. Reported cases are from 2021 to March 31st, 2022. Unknown denominator.

Supplementary Table 3. Evidence Profile for Semaglutide 2.4 mg

Question: Semaglutide plus lifestyle intervention compared to lifestyle intervention alone for management of obesity

Certainty assessment							№ of patients		Effect		Certain ty	Importanc e
№ of studi es	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsisten cy	Indirectne ss	Imprecisi on	Other consideratio ns	Semagluti de plus lifestyle interventi on	lifestyle interventi on alone	Relati ve (95% CI)	Absolu te (95% CI)		
Total body weight loss (%TBWL) (assessed with: Percentage %)												
8	randomiz ed trials	not serio us	not serious ^{a, b}	not serious	not serious	none	2658	1694	-	MD 10.76 more (8.73 more to 12.8 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
≥5% TBWL												
6	randomiz ed trials	not serio us	not serious ^{a, c}	not serious	not serious	none	2094/2543 (82.3%)	485/1583 (30.6%)	RR 2.74 (2.21 to 3.40)	533 more per 1,000 (from 371 more to 735 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
≥10% TBWL												
6	randomis ed trials	not serio us	not serious ^{a, c}	not serious	not serious	none	1651/2543 (64.9%)	195/1583 (12.3%)	RR 5.25 (3.61 to 7.64)	524 more per 1,000 (from 322 more to 818 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
≥15% TBWL												

6	randomised trials	not serious	not serious ^{a, c}	not serious	not serious	none	1172/2543 (46.1%)	86/1583 (5.4%)	RR 7.82 (5.19 to 11.76)	371 more per 1,000 (from 228 more to 585 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
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Weight loss (assessed with kilograms)

6	randomised trials	not serious	not serious ^{a, b}	not serious	not serious	none	2544	1584	-	MD 10.81 higher (8.19 higher to 13.43 higher)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	IMPORTANT
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Serious Adverse Events (SAE)

8	randomised trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	serious ^d	none	254/2657 (9.6%)	120/1696 (7.1%)	RR 1.38 (1.10 to 1.73)	27 more per 1,000 (from 7 more to 52 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	CRITICAL
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Treatment discontinuation due to adverse events

8	randomised trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	not serious ^e	none	170/2657 (6.4%)	52/1696 (3.1%)	RR 2.10 (1.54 to 2.86)	34 more per 1,000 (from 17 more to 57 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
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CI: confidence interval; MD: mean difference; RR: risk ratio

Explanations

- There was inconsistency noted, but it was in the same direction and did not cross the minimally important difference (MID) threshold that we determined a priori at 3%. Thus, we decided to not rate down.

- b. The inconsistency can be explained by Davies 2021 including patients with T2DM, while Wilding 2021 does not. Thus, the %TBWL appears to be less in patients who have T2DM.
- c. The inconsistency can be explained by Wadden 2021 including intensive behavioral therapy and initial low-calorie diet in both arms. Thus, this minimizes the difference between both arms for this dichotomous outcome
- d. Absolute risk crosses threshold of 1%, which was the pre-determined MID threshold.
- e. Forced titration expected to be captured in this outcome

Supplementary Table 4. Serious adverse events from studies, the FDA, and contraindications for Liraglutide 3.0 mg

Contraindications ^a	Serious Adverse Reactions FDA ^b	Serious Adverse Reactions original studies' definitions
1. Pregnancy 2. Patients with a personal or family history of medullary thyroid cancer (MTC) or in patients with Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia syndrome type 2 (MEN 2) 3. Should not be used with other GLP-1 RAs or DPP4 inhibitors 4. In patients treated with insulin or insulin secretagogues (eg sulfonylureas), caution is advised for hypoglycemia and proper dose adjustments may be necessary	1. Pancreatitis: 40 required hospitalizations, and 1 was life-threatening (out of approximately 29,277 who took liraglutide between 2015 and 2018) – 0.1% 2. No life-threatening or fatal breast cancers (between 2015 and 2018) 4. 0 cases of MTC 5. 17 cases of cholelithiasis requiring hospitalization – 0.05% 6. Five cases of renal failure, of which 3 needed hospitalizations, 1 was life-threatening, and 1 death occurred – 0.01% 7. 18 cases of dehydration, of which 16 were hospitalized, 1 life-threatening and 1 caused disability – 0.06% 8. Nausea/vomiting: 36 cases required hospitalization, 1 life-threatening, and 1 death – 0.1% 9. 1 case of hypoglycemia requiring hospitalization 10. 6 cases of serious suicidal behavior (one completed suicide) while the other 5 needed hospitalization or were life-threatening – 0.02%	Rubino 2022 (STEP 8): Malignant neoplasms: 3 (including 2 breast cancers) in liraglutide vs. 1 breast cancer in placebo Severe GI adverse events occurred in 3 in liraglutide group vs 3 in placebo group 1 acute pancreatitis in liraglutide vs none in placebo O'Neil 2018: 0 acute pancreatitis in liraglutide vs 1 in placebo 3 neoplasms in liraglutide vs 4 in placebo group, but no pancreatic cancer or breast cancer Lundgren 2021: 2/49 severe cases of cholelithiasis in liraglutide group vs 0 for placebo 1/49 cases of acute pancreatitis vs 0 in the placebo group Davies 2015: 1/422 breast cancer in liraglutide vs 0/212 in placebo group

		Severe hypoglycemia occurred in 3/422 subjects taking liraglutide vs 0/212 subjects taking placebo (in those also on sulfonylureas) Pi-Sunyer 2015: 1 participant died in the liraglutide group and 2 in the placebo group. 20/2481 subjects in the liraglutide group had gallstones that were classified as SAE vs 5/1242 in the placebo group 1/2481 acute pancreatitis events with liraglutide that were classified as severe 4/2481 breast cancer in liraglutide vs 1/1242 in placebo (these were advanced node + breast malignancies) 6/2481 participants in liraglutide group had active suicidal ideation (SI) vs 3/1242 in the placebo group. Garvey 2020: 3/198 events of severe hypoglycemia with liraglutide vs 2/198 with placebo 6/198 malignant neoplasms in liraglutide vs 2/198 in placebo were considered SAE 0/198 invasive lobular breast cancer with liraglutide vs 1/198 with placebo Wadden 2013:
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		3/212 had malignant neoplasms (including 2 breast cancers) vs 2/210 in placebo (neither were breast cancer in placebo group) Astrup 2012: 1 SAE related to cholelithiasis + acute pancreatitis in liraglutide vs 0 in placebo Gudbergson 2021: 1/80 with GI related SAE in liraglutide (ileus) vs 1/76 GI related SAE in placebo (cholecystitis) Wadden 2020: 1 acute cholecystitis, 1 papillary thyroid cancer in liraglutide vs none in placebo
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a. Product labeling

b. FDA definition: An adverse event when the patient outcome is death, life-threatening, hospitalization, disability of permanent damage, congenital anomaly/birth defect, development of drug dependence or drug abuse (FDA Adverse Event Reporting System Database)

c. Reported cases are from 2015 to 2018 in the FAERS database. Unknown denominator but one study reports with 29277 users between 2015-2018 who used liraglutide 3.0 mg [ref DOI: 10.1111/dom.14367]

Supplementary Table 5. Evidence Profile for Liraglutide 3.0 mg

Certainty assessment							№ of patients		Effect		Certainty	Importance
№ of studies	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsistency	Indirectness	Imprecision	Other considerations	Liraglutide	Control	Relative (95% CI)	Absolute (95% CI)		
Weight loss (follow-up: range 52 weeks to 68 weeks; assessed with: kilograms)												
9	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	not serious	none	3547	2129	-	MD 5.3 lower (5.9 lower to 4.7 lower)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	IMPORTANT
Percent total body weight loss (follow-up: range 52 weeks to 68 weeks)												
8	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	not serious	none	3710	2258	-	MD 4.81 higher (4.23 higher to 5.39 higher)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
Total body weight loss ≥ 5% (follow-up: range 52 weeks to 68 weeks)												
11	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^a	not serious	not serious	none	2379/3964 (60.0%)	662/2498 (26.5%)	RR 2.09 (1.80 to 2.42)	289 more per 1,000 (from 212 more to 376 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
Total Body Weight Loss ≥ 10% (follow-up: range 52 weeks to 68 weeks)												
11	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	not serious	none	1208/3953 (30.6%)	259/2497 (10.4%)	RR 2.67 (2.14 to 3.34)	173 more per 1,000 (from 118 more to	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL

										243 more)		
Total Body Weight Loss ≥ 15% (follow-up: range 52 weeks to 68 weeks)												
6	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	not serious	none	439/2958 (14.8%)	77/1704 (4.5%)	RR 3.04 (2.25 to 4.12)	92 more per 1,000 (from 56 more to 141 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	IMPORTA NT
Serious Adverse Events (follow-up: range 52 weeks to 68 weeks)												
11	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	serious ^b	none	275/3964 (6.9%)	139/2498 (5.6%)	RR 1.22 (1.00 to 1.50)	12 more per 1,000 (from 0 fewer to 28 more)	⊕⊕⊕○ Moderate	CRITICAL
Treatment discontinuations due to adverse effects (follow-up: range 52 weeks to 68 weeks)												
10	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	not serious	none	373/3914 (9.5%)	98/2448 (4.0%)	RR 2.31 (1.85 to 2.88)	52 more per 1,000 (from 34 more to 75 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL

CI: confidence interval; MD: mean difference; RR: risk ratio

Explanations

a. I-squared = 65% and largely influenced by study by Lundgren et al. in which participants had already lost significant body weight during 8-week run-in period, but not rated down as sensitivity analysis by excluding this study did not show a significant change in pooled effect size

b. 95% CI extends from no harms to clinically significant SAE

Supplementary Table 6. Serious adverse events from studies, the FDA and contraindications for Phentermine-topiramate ER

Contraindications	Serious Adverse Reactions FDA ^b	Selected Serious Adverse Reactions original studies' definitions
1. Pregnancy 2. Glaucoma 3. Hyperthyroidism 4. During or within 14 days of taking monoamine oxidase inhibitors 5. Known hypersensitivity or idiosyncrasy to sympathomimetic amines	1. Neurologic (e.g., blurry vision or vision disturbance, seizure, cerebrovascular accident (CVA), paresthesia, dizziness, loss of consciousness, glaucoma, SI, anxiety, change in HR, attention/thinking disturbance): 105 cases reported (~0.6%) ^c 2. General disorders (nephrolithiasis, arrhythmia, vision disturbance, mental disturbance, SI): 79 cases reported (~0.5%) 3. GI (e.g., constipation, abdominal pain, nausea, dry mouth, diarrhea, constipation, change in taste, cholelithiasis, pancreatitis): 51 cases reported (~0.37%) ^c 4. Psychiatric (e.g., anxiety, depression, SI, sleep disorder): 74 cases reported (~0.39%) ^c 5. 7 deaths	1. Gadde 2011: Cardiac (coronary artery disease, myocardial infarction (MI), cardio-respiratory arrest, angina pectoris, acute coronary syndrome, atrial fibrillation, tachycardia) Intervention 15 mg/92 mg: 5/994; Placebo: 7/993 Cholelithiasis: I: 1/994 and C: 1/993 Syncope/Headache/Dizziness: I: 1/994 vs C: 3/993 Nephrolithiasis: I: 2/994 vs C: 0/993

a. Product labeling

b. FDA definition: An adverse event when the patient outcome is death, life-threatening, hospitalization, disability of permanent damage, congenital anomaly/birth defect, development of drug dependence or drug abuse (FDA Adverse Event Reporting System Database). See full list on the public database.

c. Reported cases are from 2012 to March 31st, 2022. Unknown denominator but, one study reports with 11,513 users between 2015-2018 that would account for an indirect estimate of 0.3- 1 % SAE [ref DOI: 10.1111/dom.14367]

Supplementary Table 7. Evidence Profile for Phentermine-topiramate ER

Question: Phentermine/Topiramate (15 mg/92 mg) plus lifestyle intervention compared to lifestyle intervention alone for management of obesity

No of studies	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsistency	Indirectness	Imprecision	Other considerations	Phentermine/Topiramate (15/92 mg) plus lifestyle intervention	lifestyle intervention alone	Relative (95% CI)	Absolute (95% CI)		
Total body weight loss (%TBWL) (assessed with: Percentage %)												
3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^a	not serious	not serious	none	1580	1561	-	MD 8.45 % higher (7.89 higher to 9.01 higher)	⊕⊕⊕ ⊕ High	CRITICAL
≥5% TBWL												
3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^a	not serious	not serious	none	1068/1580 (67.6%)	303/1561 (19.4%)	RR 3.48 (3.13 to 3.87)	481 more per 1,000 (from 413 more to 557 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ⊕ High	CRITICAL
≥10% TBWL												
3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^a	not serious	not serious	none	730/1580 (46.2%)	114/1561 (7.3%)	RR 6.33 (5.26 to 7.61)	389 more per 1,000 (from 311 more to 483 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ⊕ High	CRITICAL
≥15% TBWL												
1	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	serious ^b	none	161/511 (31.5%)	17/513 (3.3%)	RR 9.51 (5.86	282 more per	⊕⊕⊕ ○ High	CRITICAL

									to 15.44)	1,000 (from 161 more to 479 more)	Moderate	
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Serious Adverse Events (SAE)

3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	serious ^{b,c}	none	67/1580 (4.2%)	55/1561 (3.5%)	RR 1.20 (0.85 to 1.70)	7 more per 1,000 (from 5 fewer to 25 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	CRITICAL
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Treatment discontinuation due to adverse events

3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	not serious	none	275/1580 (17.4%)	132/1561 (8.5%)	RR 2.08 (1.71 to 2.52)	91 more per 1,000 (from 60 more to 129 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ⊕ High	CRITICAL
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CI: confidence interval; MD: mean difference; RR: risk ratio

Explanations

a. Allison 2012; BMI ≥35

b. Less than 300 events

c. crosses unity

Supplementary Table 8. SAE FAERS for Bupropion-naltrexone ER

Contraindications ^a	Serious Adverse Reactions FDA ^b	Serious Adverse Reactions original studies' definitions ^d
1. Chronic opioid therapy 2. Need for short-term opioid analgesics 3. Uncontrolled hypertension 4. Seizure disorder, history of seizures, or risk of seizures 5. Use during or within 14 days following MAO inhibitor 6. Pregnancy 7. While not contraindication, check drug-drug interactions	1. Neurologic (e.g., dizziness, seizure, CVA, headache): 93 cases reported (~0.1%) ^c 2. GI (e.g., nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, constipation, cholecystitis): 103 cases reported (~0.1%) ^c 3. Psychiatric (e.g., anxiety, depression, SI): 75 cases reported (> 0.1%) ^c	1. Apovian 2013 1/992 (0.1%) passive suicidal ideation, 1/992 (0.1%) seizure 2. Wadden 2010 2/584 (0.3%): cholecystitis 3. Nissen 2016 CV events: all death, nonfatal stroke, MI: 40/4455 (0.9%) vs 62/4450 (1.4%) in placebo 4. Greenway 2010 2/573 (0.3%): cardiac (1 heart failure, 1 MI) 0/573 stroke 5. Internal SR MA seizure - 0.1% vs 0% in placebo, SI in 1/ 3,239 (0.03%) vs 3/1,515 (0.20%) in placebo

a. Product labeling

b. FDA definition: An adverse event when the patient outcome is death, life-threatening, hospitalization, disability of permanent damage, congenital anomaly/birth defect, development of drug dependence or drug abuse (FDA Adverse Event Reporting System Database)

c. Reported cases are from 2014 to Dec 31st, 2021. Unknown denominator but, one study reports with 42 138 users between 2015-2018 that would account for 0.5-1 % all SAE [ref DOI: 10.1111/dom.14367]

d. Nissen: CV events, including all death, nonfatal stroke, or nonfatal MI infarction and hospitalization, Greenway: by good clinical practice (same as FDA)

Supplementary Table 9. Evidence Profile for Naltrexone-bupropion ER

Certainty assessment							№ of patients		Effect		Certainty	Importance
№ of studies	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsistency	Indirectness	Imprecision	Other considerations	NB32	No treatment	Relative (95% CI)	Absolute (95% CI)		
Weight loss in kg												
5	randomized trials	not serious _{a,b}	not serious ^c	not serious	serious ^{d,e}	none	6772	5887	-	MD 3.01 kg fewer (3.39 fewer to 2.62 fewer)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	IMPORTANT
%TBWL												
5	randomized trials	not serious _{a,b}	not serious ^c	not serious	serious ^{d,e}	none	6772	5887	-	MD 3.01 % lower (3.54 lower to 2.47 lower)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	CRITICAL
TBWL >5%												
4	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^f	not serious	not serious	none	949/2317 (41.0%)	247/1437 (17.2%)	RR 2.18 (1.41 to 3.37)	203 more per 1,000 (from 70 more to 407 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
TBWL >10%												
4	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^f	not serious	not serious	none	559/2317 (24.1%)	105/1437 (7.3%)	RR 3.04 (1.80 to 5.14)	151 more per 1,000 (from 58 more to 303 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL

TBWL >15%

3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^f	not serious	not serious	none	279/2052 (13.6%)	39/1278 (3.1%)	RR 3.88 (2.13 to 7.08)	88 more per 1,000 (from 34 more to 186 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	IMPORTANT
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Treatment discontinuation due to AE

5	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^g	not serious	not serious	none	1798/6947 (25.9%)	545/5892 (9.2%)	RR 2.39 (1.69 to 3.37)	129 more per 1,000 (from 64 more to 219 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
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Serious adverse events

5	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	serious ^h	none	67/6947 (1.0%)	78/5892 (1.3%)	RR 0.74 (0.53 to 1.03)	3 fewer per 1,000 (from 6 fewer to 0 fewer)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	CRITICAL
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a. Apovian 2013, had imputation in the analysis for week 56. After re-randomization, patients receiving a higher dose of Naltrexone were excluded from the final analysis, and participants receiving FDA approved dose were counted twice "double-weighted". These were not many participants, and the panel did not estimate they would impact the pool estimate.

b. To deal with attrition bias most studies used intention to treat (ITT) and total original number was used as the last observation carried forward. However, Hollander et al report only on modified ITT analysis and excluded subjects that discontinued the drug within first 4 weeks, the majority due to side effects. We explored this in a sensitivity analysis and there was no large difference between the results. Thus, we decided not to rate down for risk of bias (RoB)

c. Although I^2 was high, all the studies were showing benefit, so we did not rate down for inconsistency

d. Minimal important difference (MID) or clinically important threshold below which there is no clear benefit of the intervention in discussion with the guideline panel and technical review team was determined to be 3kg (or ~3%)

e. We noted serious imprecision as the lower confidence limit crosses the minimal important difference (MID) for benefit.

f. Although I^2 was high, all studies showed clear benefits. Furthermore, the Wadden study that was inconsistent with the results from the other studies was conducted with high intensity behavior modification that may have lead to a ceiling effect. However, we performed a sensitivity analysis to explore and the results were not significantly different

g. Although I^2 was high, all the studies were showing harm, so we did not rate down for inconsistency

h. Low event rate and CI crossed the line of no effect

Supplementary Table 10. Serious adverse events from studies, the FDA and contraindications for orlistat.

Contraindications ^a	FAERS data on Orlistat from 2015 to 2018 ^b	Selected Serious Adverse Reactions original studies' definitions
1. Pregnancy 2. Patients with chronic malabsorption syndrome 3. Patients with cholestasis 4. Patients are strongly encouraged to take a multivitamin supplement that contains fat-soluble vitamins to ensure adequate nutrition because Orlistat has been shown to reduce the absorption of fat-soluble vitamins and beta-carotene	1. Liver failure: 12 cases outside the US with Orlistat 120mg and 1 case in the US with Orlistat 60 mg reported between April 1999 and August 2009 out of an estimated 40 million people worldwide who have used either of these medications 2. There were 4 cases of pancreatic cancer, of which 2 died 3. 4 cases of renal failure reported among 1341 patients (only in 2017 in FAERS)^c	Davidson 1999: no major SAE in either Orlistat or placebo groups. Broom 2002 (one of the larger studies with 265 subjects in orlistat and 266 in placebo – none of the SAE were thought to be attributable to Orlistat. Sjöström 1998: SAE were reported by 25 out of 345 participants on Orlistat vs 24 out of 343 patients on placebo in year 1, of which only one SAE was judged by the investigators to be related to treatment. Similarly, 2 SAE were judged by the investigators to be possibly related to treatment during year 2. Torgerson (XENDOS) 2004: Over the 4-year study period, a similar proportion of Orlistat and placebo-treated subjects had at least one SAE (15 vs. 13%) Lindgärde 2000: A total of 19 participants out of 190 in the orlistat group and 5 out of 186 in the placebo group experienced SAE, none of which were deemed by the investigators to have a causal relationship with the study medication.

a. Product labeling

b. FDA definition: An adverse event when the patient outcome is death, life-threatening, hospitalization, disability of permanent damage, congenital anomaly/birth defect, development of drug dependence or drug abuse (FDA Adverse Event Reporting System Database)

Supplementary Table 11. Evidence Profile for Orlistat

Certainty assessment							№ of patients		Effect		Certainty	Importance
№ of studies	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsistency	Indirectness	Imprecision	Other considerations	Orlistat	Controls	Relative (95% CI)	Absolute (95% CI)		
Weight loss (follow-up: range 48 weeks to 4 years; assessed with: kilograms)												
23 (24 cohorts)	randomized trials	not serious ^a	not serious	not serious	serious ^b	none	4166	3601	-	MD 2.81 lower (3.45 lower to 2.17 lower)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	IMPORTANT
Percent total body weight loss (follow-up: range 48 weeks to 4 years)												
15 (16 cohorts)	randomized trials	not serious ^a	not serious ^c	not serious	serious ^b	none	3514	3004	-	MD 2.78 higher (2.36 higher to 3.2 higher)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	CRITICAL
Total body weight loss ≥5% (follow-up: range 48 weeks to 4 years)												
18	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^d	not serious	not serious	none	3303/5638 (58.6%)	1824/5201 (35.1%)	RR 1.71 (1.55 to 1.88)	249 more per 1,000 (from 193 more to 309 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
Total body weight loss ≥10% (follow-up: range 48 weeks to 4 years)												
15	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^e	not serious	not serious	none	1577/5083 (31.0%)	715/4652 (15.4%)	RR 1.94 (1.70 to 2.22)	144 more per 1,000 (from 108	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL

										more to 188 more)		
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Severe adverse events (follow-up: range 48 weeks to 4 years)

11	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	serious ^f	none	362/3542 (10.2%)	329/3545 (9.3%)	RR 1.04 (0.81 to 1.33)	4 more per 1,000 (from 18 fewer to 31 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Moderate	CRITICAL
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Treatment discontinuations due to adverse events (follow-up: range 48 weeks to 4 years)

20	randomized trials	not serious	not serious ^g	not serious	not serious	none	339/4252 (8.0%)	195/3804 (5.1%)	RR 1.51 (1.22 to 1.89)	26 more per 1,000 (from 11 more to 46 more)	⊕⊕⊕⊕ High	CRITICAL
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CI: confidence interval; MD: mean difference; RR: risk ratio

Explanations

a. Although most studies did not explain the method of randomization or how allocation was concealed, we did not think it would introduce serious RoB as most studies were double-blinded and although there was attrition seen in several studies, it was usually not disproportionate and LOCF analysis method used for ITT analysis. Thus we did not rate down for RoB

b. 95% CI includes minimal clinically important difference

c. There was moderate heterogeneity ($I^2 = 39\%$), but not rated down as the inconsistency was largely driven by the magnitude and not the direction of effects

d. There was substantial heterogeneity ($I^2 = 73\%$), but not rated down as the inconsistency was largely driven by the magnitude and not the direction of effects

e. There was moderate heterogeneity ($I^2 = 46\%$), but not rated down as the inconsistency was mostly due to the magnitude and not the direction of effects

f. 95% CI is wide and includes 1

g. There was moderate heterogeneity present ($I^2 = 30\%$), but not rated down as the inconsistency was largely driven by the magnitude and not the direction of effects

Supplementary Table 12. Serious adverse events from studies, the FDA and contraindications for phentermine.

Contraindications ^a	Serious Adverse Reactions FDA ^{b, c}	Serious Adverse Reactions original studies' definitions ^e
1. History of cardiovascular disease (arrhythmias, heart failure, CAD, stroke, uncontrolled hypertension) 2. Hyperthyroidism 3. Glaucoma 4. Agitated states 5. History of drug abuse 6. Use during or within 14 days following MAO inhibitor 7. Pregnancy and/ or breast-feeding	1. Cardiac disorders (e.g., valve disease, MI, arrhythmias CHF, palpitations, tachycardia): 2,554 cases reported (~ 0.05% incidence) 2. Primary pulmonary hypertension - 672 cases reported ^d (~ 0.0008%) 3. CNS effects (e.g., delirium, mania, psychosis, insomnia, irritability, and anxiety): 1,434 cases (~0.01%) 4. Neurologic (dizziness, headache, amnesia, syncope CVA): 1,394 cases reported (~0.01%)	Aronne 2013 1/109 (1%): chest pain Kim 2006 3/28 (10%): severe headache and nausea 1/28 (3%): dry mouth Tsai 2012 3/ 23 (13%): clinically significant BP elevation 1/ 23 (4%): HR elevation

a. Product labeling

b. FDA definition: An adverse event when the patient outcome is death, life-threatening, hospitalization, disability of permanent damage, congenital anomaly/birth defect, development of drug dependence or drug abuse (FDA Adverse Event Reporting System Database)

c. All SAE reported cases are from 1975 to 2021. Unknown denominator but is widely prescribed AOM in the United States, with 116,435 users between 2015-2018 [doi.org/10.1111/dom.14367]

d. Appears to be associated with more extended use. Pulmonary hypertension and valvulopathies were noted in patients using phentermine in combination with fenfluramine.

e. No definitions were provided for SAE in any of the studies

Supplementary Table 13. Evidence Profile for Phentermine

Certainty assessment							№ of patients		Effect		Certainty	Importance
№ of studies	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsistency	Indirectness	Imprecision	Other	Phentermine/ diet/ exercise	SOC (diet/exercise)	Relative (95% CI)	Absolute (95% CI)		
Weight loss (kg)												
7	randomized trials	not serious ^a	serious ^{b,c}	serious ^d	not serious	none	353	343	-	MD 4.74 kg more (5.73 more to 3.75 more)	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	IMPORTANT
%TBWL												
3	randomized trials	not serious ^a	not serious	serious ^d	serious ^{b,e}	none	205	202	-	MD 3.63 % more (4.29 more to 2.97 more)	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	CRITICAL
> 5% TBWL												
5	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	serious ^d	not serious	none	173/322 (53.7%)	40/313 (12.8%)	RR 4.12 (3.04 to 5.59)	399 more per 1,000 (from 261 more to 587 more)	⊕⊕⊕○ Moderate	CRITICAL
>10% TBWL												
5	randomized trials	not serious	serious ^f	serious ^d	not serious ^g	none	81/322 (25.2%)	15/313 (4.8%)	RR 5.10 (3.02 to 8.61)	196 more per 1,000 (from 97	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	CRITICAL

										more to 365 more)		
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Treatment discontinuation due to side effects

7	randomized trials	not serious ^h	not serious	serious ^d	not serious	none	257/1274 (20.2%)	76/730 (10.4%)	RR 1.73 (1.36 to 2.19)	76 more per 1,000 (from 37 more to 124 more)	⊕⊕⊕○ Moderate	CRITICAL
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Severe Adverse Events

5	randomized trials	not serious ^h	not serious	serious ^d	serious ⁱ	none	11/280 (3.9%)	3/276 (1.1%)	RR 2.44 (0.60 to 10.03)	16 more per 1,000 (from 4 fewer to 98 more)	⊕⊕○ Low	CRITICAL
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- Although there was a concern for attrition bias, in almost all the studies that have attrition, it was very similar between the 2 groups. Thus, we did not rate down for RoB
- Minimal important difference (MID) or clinically important threshold below which there is no clear benefit of the intervention in discussion with the guideline panel and technical review team was determined to be 3 kg (or ~3%)
- There is a serious inconsistency between the studies because some studies are showing clear benefits with both upper and lower confidence intervals being above the MID, while other studies failed to show clear clinical benefit as the point estimate and the lower confidence limit are below the MID
- Serious indirectness in the intervention duration. Our PICO question is weight loss treatment for a long-term therapy that most studies define as 1 year. However, the available data is mostly 3-6 months.
- Confidence interval is crossing the MID, the lower CI is showing clear benefits while the upper failed to show clear clinical benefit as higher confidence limit is below the MID
- Serious inconsistency possibly due to different intervention duration and follow-up time
- Concern for serious imprecision due to wide CI, but because this was most likely related to the inconsistency already accounted for, it was decided not to rate down for imprecision
- Although some smaller and older studies did not blind, overall, there was no concern for serious RoB across the pool of evidence
- Low event number

Supplementary Table 14. Evidence Profile for Diethylpropion

Certainty assessment							№ of patients		Effect		Certainty	Importance
№ of studies	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsistency	Indirectness	Imprecision	Other considerations	Diethylpropion + SOC (diet and exercise)	SOC (diet and exercise)	Relative (95% CI)	Absolute (95% CI)		
Weight loss (kg)												
6	randomized trials	serious ^a	serious ^{b,c}	serious ^d	not serious	none	209	199	-	MD 4.74 kg more (6.4 more to 3.08 more)	⊕○○ ○ Very low	CRITICAL
% TBWL												
4	randomized trials	serious ^a	not serious	serious ^d	serious ^e	none	119	108	-	MD 5.36 % more (7.23 more to 3.5 more)	⊕○○ ○ Very low	CRITICAL
>5% TBWL												
3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	serious ^d	serious ^f	none	109/143 (76.2%)	26/139 (18.7%)	RR 3.51 (1.50 to 8.18)	469 more per 1,000 (from 94 more to 1,000 more)	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	CRITICAL
>10% TBWL												
3	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	serious ^d	serious ^f	none	71/143 (49.7%)	3/139 (2.2%)	RR 14.48 (5.13)	291 more per 1,000	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	CRITICAL

									to 40.80)	(from 89 more to 859 more)		
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Treatment discontinuation due to side effects

5	randomiz ed trials	not seriou s	not serious	serious ^d	serious ^f	none	10/187 (5.3%)	6/180 (3.3%)	RR 1.37 (0.51 to 3.66)	12 more per 1,000 (from 16 fewer to 89 more)	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	CRITICA L
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a. Majority of the older studies did not perform ITT analyses and only reported the benefit data from the subjects who completed the study, which probably introduced a RoB and overestimated the intervention's effect. In addition, it was unclear how the randomization and allocation were conducted in most of the studies

b. Minimal important difference (MID) or clinically important threshold below which there is no clear benefit of the intervention in discussion with the guideline panel and technical review team was determined to be 3 kg (or ~3%)

c. There is a serious inconsistency between the studies because some studies are showing clear benefits with both upper and lower confidence intervals being above the MID, while other studies failed to show clear clinical benefit as the point estimate and the lower confidence limit are below the MID

d. Serious indirectness in the intervention duration. Our PICO question is weight loss treatment for a long-term therapy that most studies define as 1 year. However, the available data is mostly 3-6 months.

e. Small sample size (<400 total participants)

f. Number of events is low (<200 events)

Supplementary Table 15. Evidence Profile for Gelesis100

Certainty assessment							№ of patients		Effect		Certain ty	Importan ce
№ of studie s	Study design	Risk of bias	Inconsisten cy	Indirectne ss	Imprecisi on	Other consideratio ns	Cellulose and citric acid hydrogel plus lifestyle interventi on	lifestyle interventi on alone	Relati ve (95% CI)	Absolu te (95% CI)		
Total body weight loss (%) (follow-up: 24 weeks; assessed with: Percentage))												
1	randomiz ed trials	not seriou s	not serious	not serious	very serious ^{a,b}	none	223	213	-	MD 2.02 % more (0.96 more to 3.08 more)	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	
At least 5% TBWL (follow-up: 24 weeks)												
1	randomiz ed trials	not seriou s	not serious	not serious	serious ^c	none	130/223 (58.3%)	90/213 (42.3%)	RR 1.38 (1.14 to 1.67)	161 more per 1,000 (from 59 more to 283 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Modera te	
At least 10% (follow-up: 24 weeks)												
1	randomis ed trials	not seriou s	not serious	not serious	serious ^c	none	61/223 (27.4%)	32/213 (15.0%)	RR 1.82 (1.24 to 2.67)	123 more per 1,000 (from 36 more to 251 more)	⊕⊕⊕ ○ Modera te	
Treatment discontinuation due to adverse events (follow-up: 24 weeks)												

1	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	very serious ^{c,d}	none	8/223 (3.6%)	7/213 (3.3%)	RR 1.09 (0.40 to 2.96)	3 more per 1,000 (from 20 fewer to 64 more)	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	
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Serious Adverse Events

1	randomized trials	not serious	not serious	not serious	very serious ^{b,c,d}	none	0/223 (0.0%)	1/213 (0.5%)	RR 0.32 (0.01 to 7.77)	3 fewer per 1,000 (from 5 fewer to 32 more)	⊕⊕○ ○ Low	
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CI: confidence interval; MD: mean difference; RR: risk ratio

Explanations

- a. Does not meet minimally important threshold of 3%
- b. Wide confidence interval
- c. Low event rate (<300 events)
- d. Crosses unity

Supplementary Figure 1. Search strategy for the Guideline

PICO 1-6

((("Obesity"[Mesh] OR "Weight Loss"[Mesh] OR "Overweight"[Mesh] OR obes*[tw] OR "body mass ind*" [tw] OR adiposity[tw] OR overweight[tw] OR "over weight"[tw] OR "overload syndrome*" [tw] OR "over eat*" [tw] OR overfeed*[tw] OR "over feed*" [tw] OR overfed[tw] OR "over fed"[tw] OR "weight cycling"[tw] OR "skinfold thickness"[tw] OR antiobesity[tw] OR "anti-obesity"[tw] OR obesitas[tw] OR bodyweight[tw] OR "body weight"[tw] OR adipositas[tw] OR BMI[tw]) AND (alli[tw] OR orlipastat[tw] OR orlistat[tw] OR "ro 18 0647"[tw] OR "ro 180647"[tw] OR ro180647[tw] OR tetrahydrolipstatin[tw] OR Xenical[tw] OR (phentermine[tw] AND topiramate[tw]) OR "phentermine topiramate"[tw] OR phenterminetopiramate[tw] OR qnexa[tw] OR qsiva[tw] OR Qsymia[tw] OR topiramatephentermine[tw] OR "phentermine-topiramate"[tw] OR (amfebutamone[tw] AND naltrexone[tw]) OR (bupropion[tw] AND naltrexone[tw]) OR Contrave[tw] OR mysimba[tw] OR "nb 32"[tw] OR nb32[tw] OR "bupropion-naltrexone"[tw] OR liraglutide[tw] OR "nn 2211"[tw] OR nn2211[tw] OR "nnc 90 1170"[tw] OR "nnc90 1170"[tw] OR Saxenda[tw] OR Victoza[tw] OR semaglutide[tw] OR nn9535[tw] OR "nn 9535"[tw] OR ozempic[tw] OR rybelsus[tw] OR "Orlistat"[Mesh] OR "Liraglutide"[Mesh] OR "semaglutide" [Supplementary Concept] OR "bupropion hydrochloride, naltrexone hydrochloride drug combination" [Supplementary Concept])) NOT (("Child"[Mesh] OR "Infant"[Mesh] OR "Adolescent"[Mesh]) NOT "Adult"[Mesh]) AND ("randomized controlled trial"[pt] OR "controlled clinical trial"[pt] OR randomized[tw] OR randomised[tw] OR placebo[tw] OR "drug therapy"[sh] OR randomly[tw] OR trial[tw] OR groups[tw]) NOT ("Animals"[sh] NOT "Humans"[sh]) AND ("2021/01/01"[Date - Publication] : "3000"[Date - Publication]))

PICO 7 and 8

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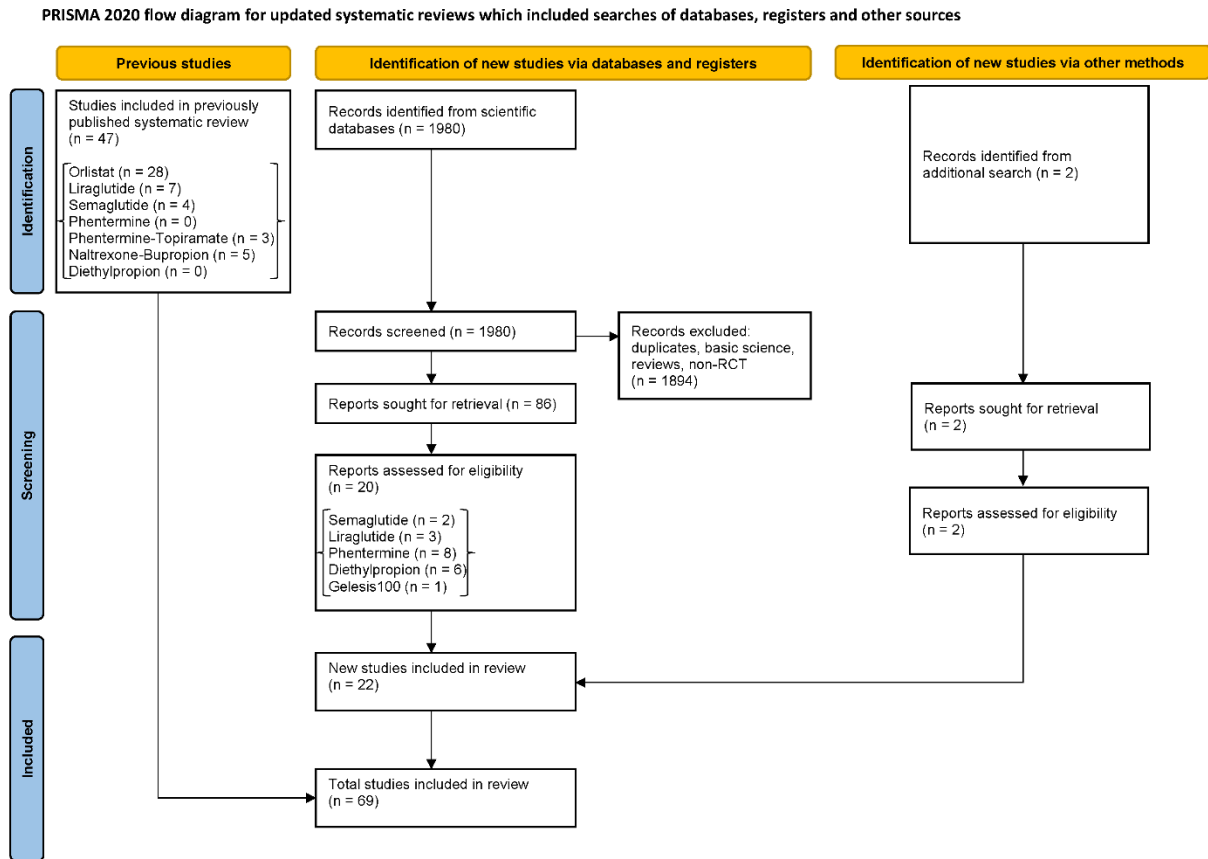
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PICO 9

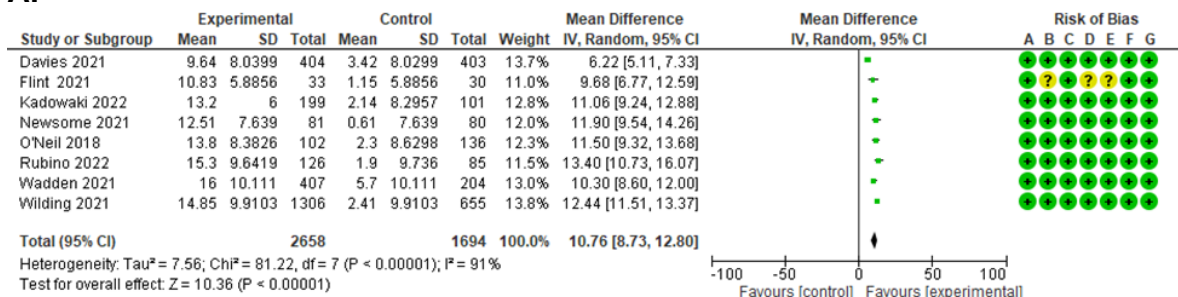
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Supplementary Figure 2. PRISMA Flow Diagram



Supplementary Figure 3. Benefits and harms of semaglutide 2.4 mg over placebo in the management of obesity: **(A)** Mean difference in % total body weight loss; **(B)** Mean difference in weight loss (in kg); **(C)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 5% total body weight loss; **(D)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 10% total body weight loss; **(E)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 15% total body weight loss; **(F)** Serious adverse events; **(G)** Discontinuation of treatment due to adverse events

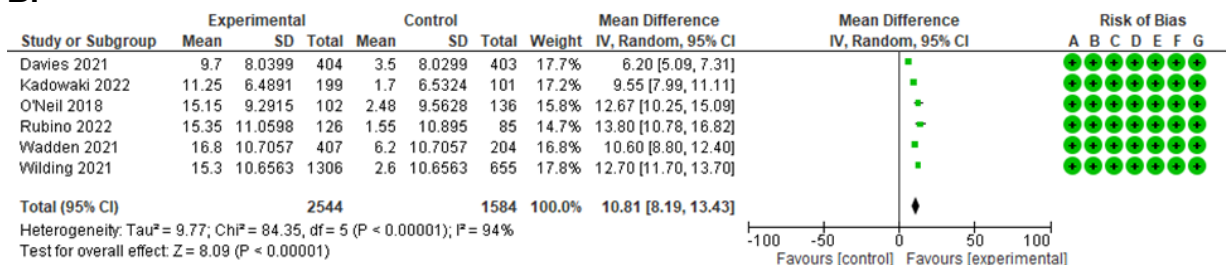
A.



Risk of bias legend

- (A) Random sequence generation (selection bias)
- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

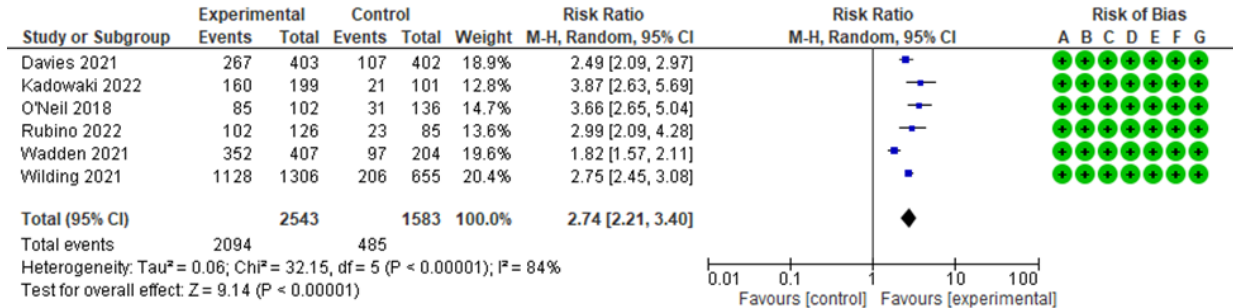
B.



Risk of bias legend

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- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

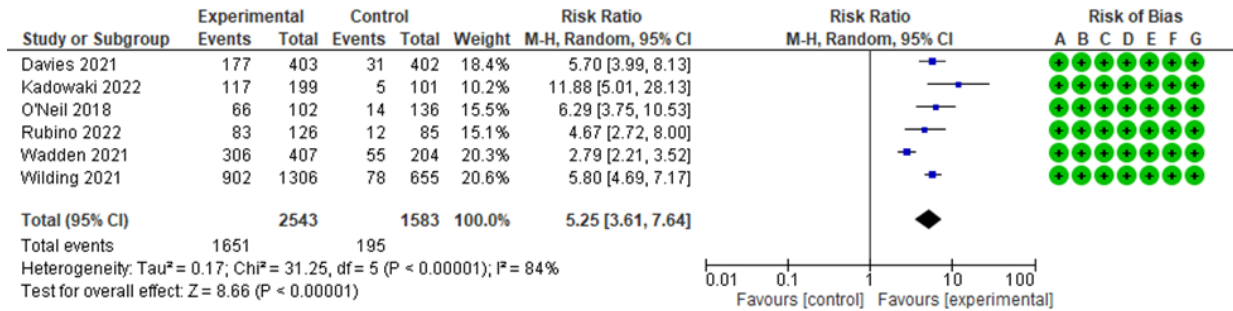
C.



Risk of bias legend

- (A) Random sequence generation (selection bias)
- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

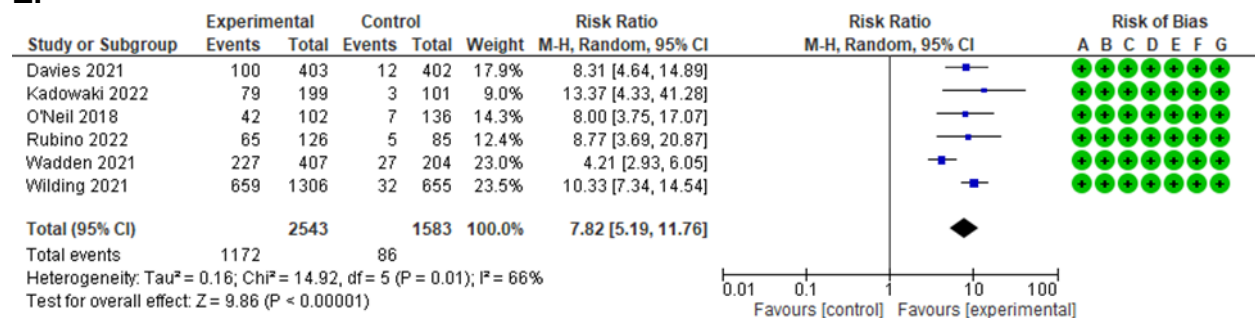
D.



Risk of bias legend

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- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

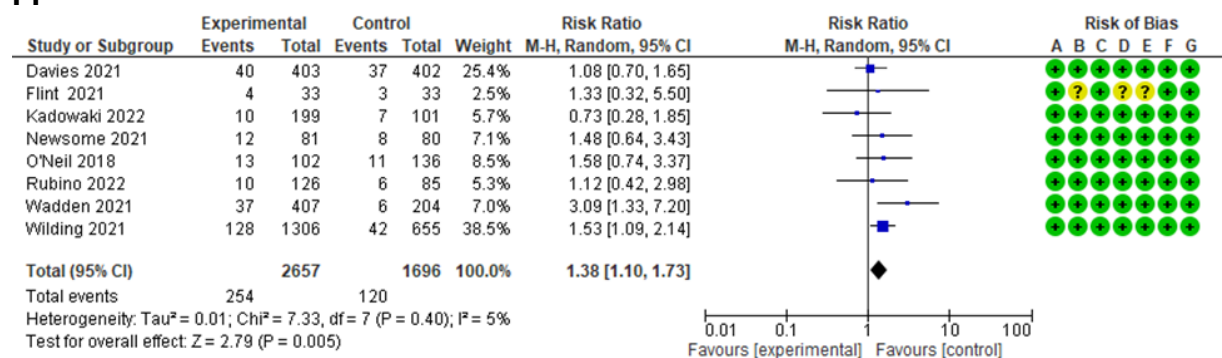
E.



Risk of bias legend

- (A) Random sequence generation (selection bias)
- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

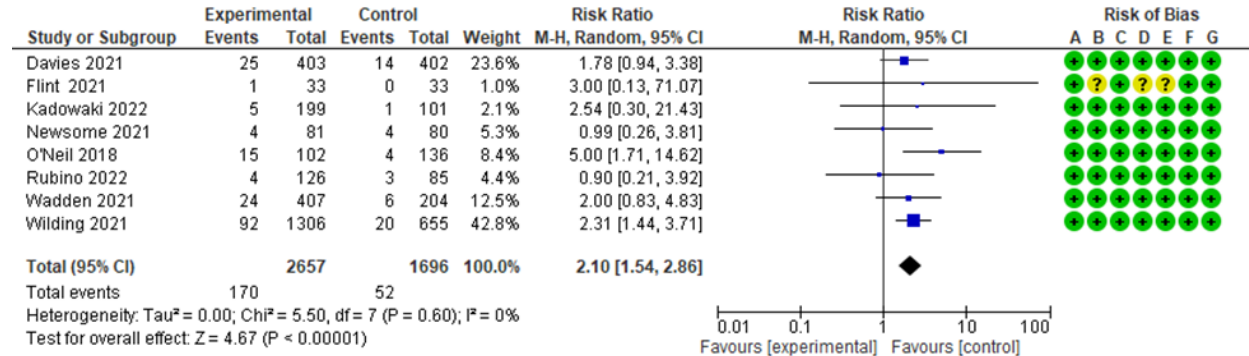
F.



Risk of bias legend

- (A) Random sequence generation (selection bias)
- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
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- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

G.

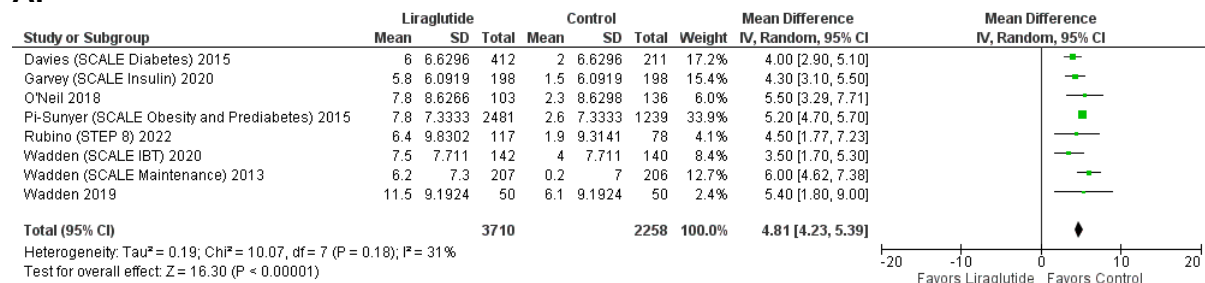


Risk of bias legend

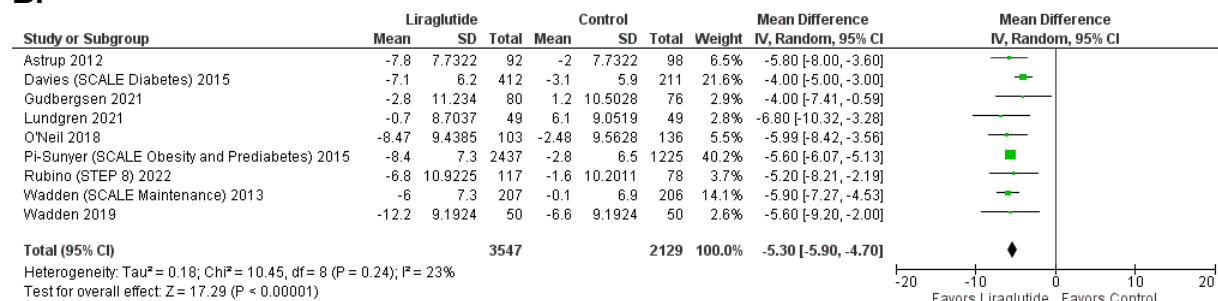
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- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

Supplementary Figure 4. Benefits and harms of liraglutide 3.0 mg over placebo in the management of obesity: **(A)** Mean difference in % total body weight loss; **(B)** Mean difference in weight loss (in kg); **(C)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 5% total body weight loss; **(D)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 10% total body weight loss; **(E)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 15% total body weight loss; **(F)** Serious adverse events; **(G)** Discontinuation of treatment due to adverse events

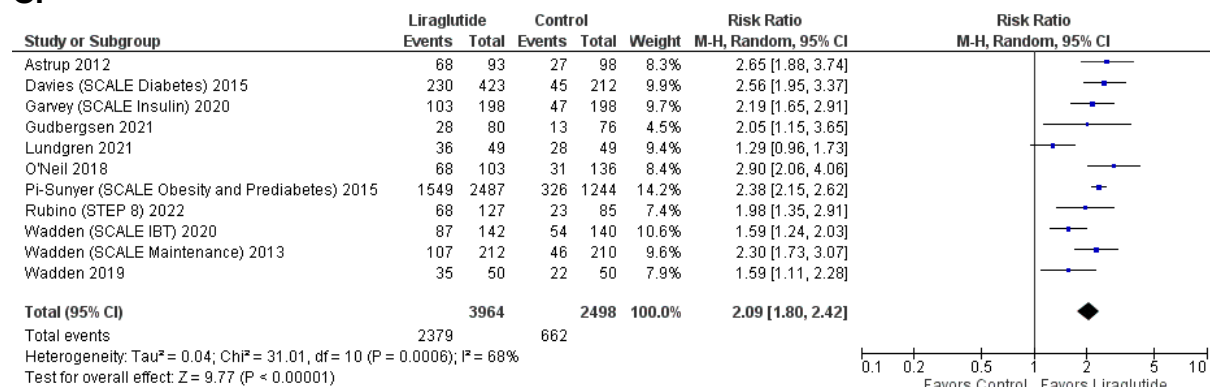
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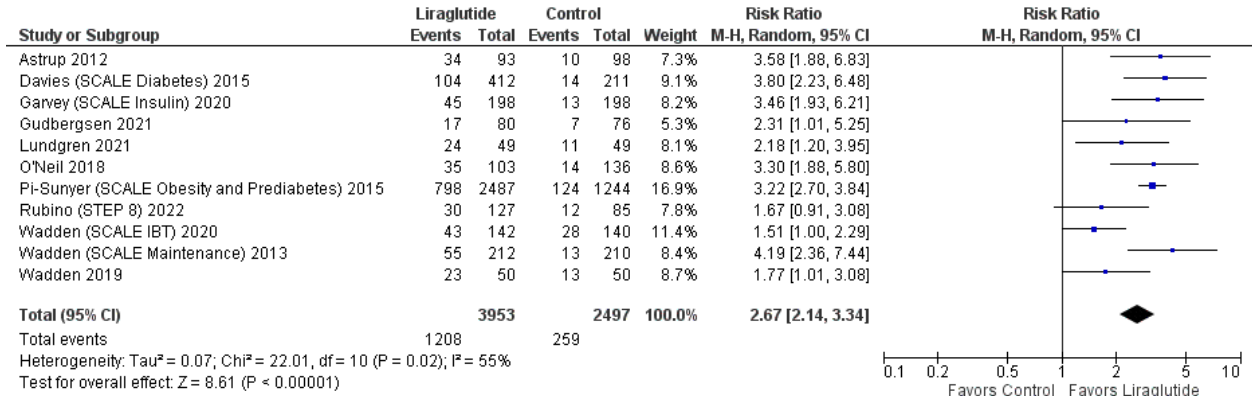
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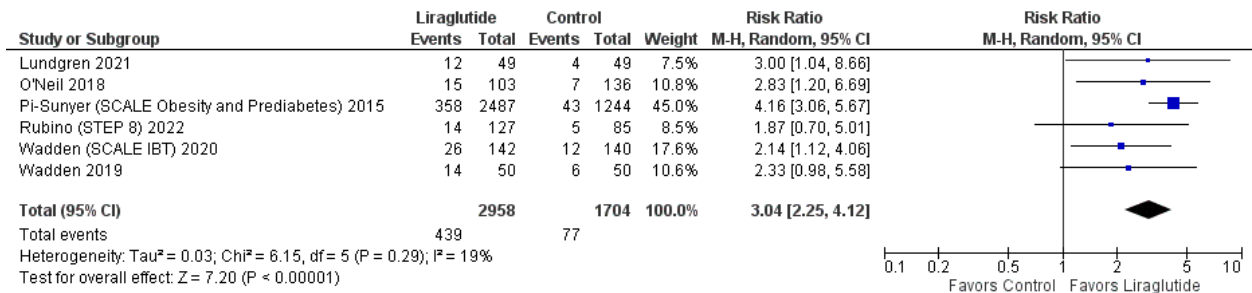
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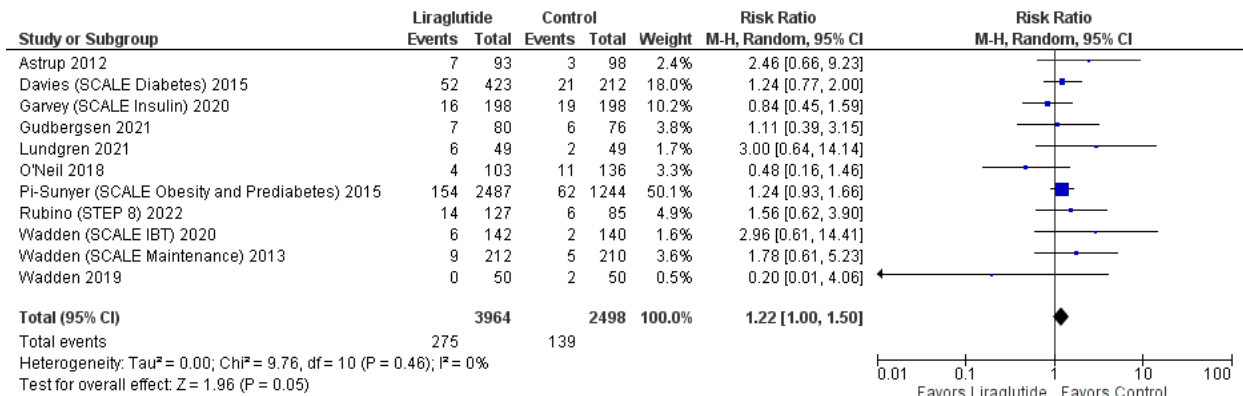
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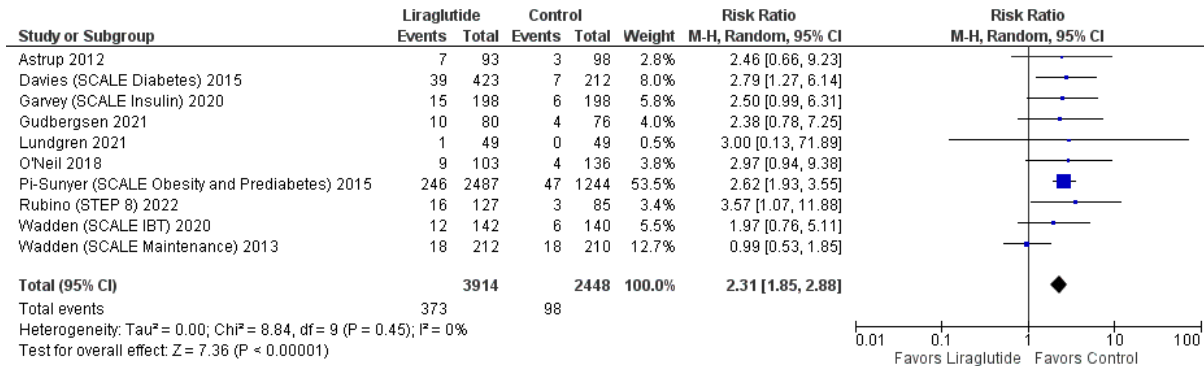
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F.

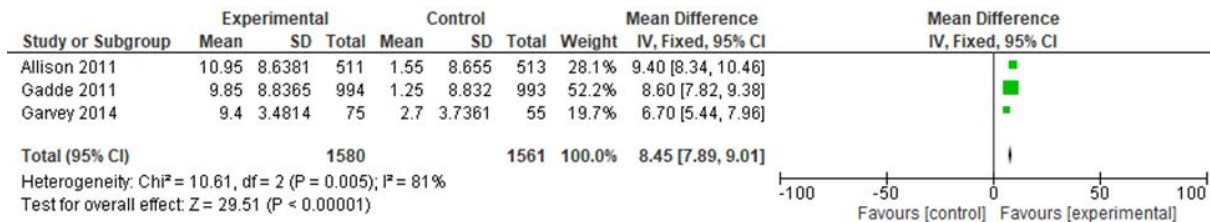


G.

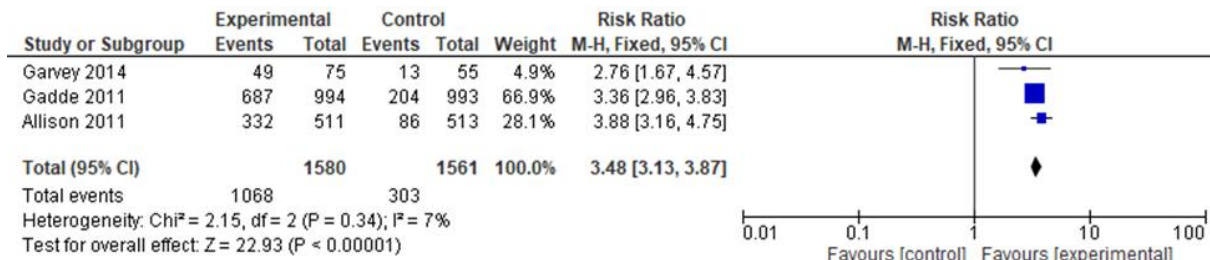


Supplementary Figure 5. Benefits and harms of phentermine-topiramate ER over placebo in the management of obesity: **(A)** Mean difference in % total body weight loss; **(B)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 5% total body weight loss; **(C)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 10% total body weight loss; **(D)** Serious adverse events; **(E)** Discontinuation of treatment due to adverse events

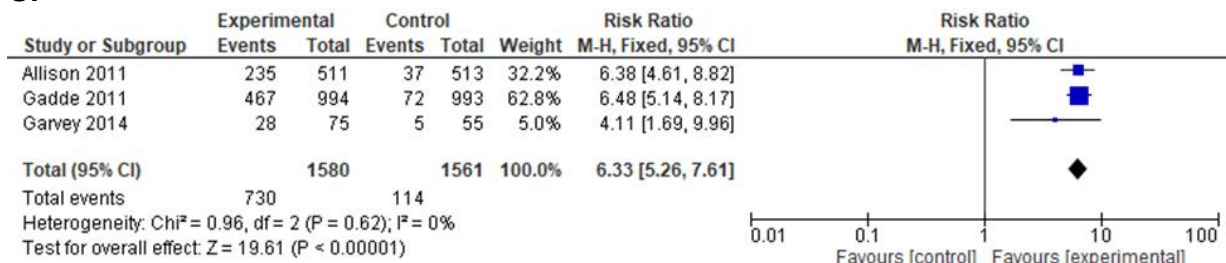
A.



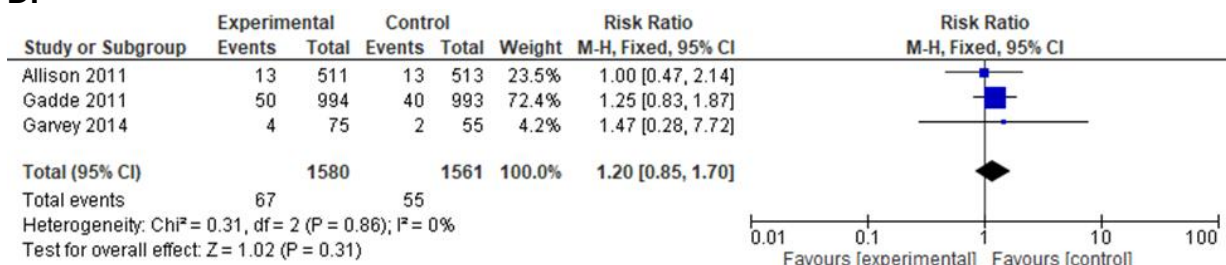
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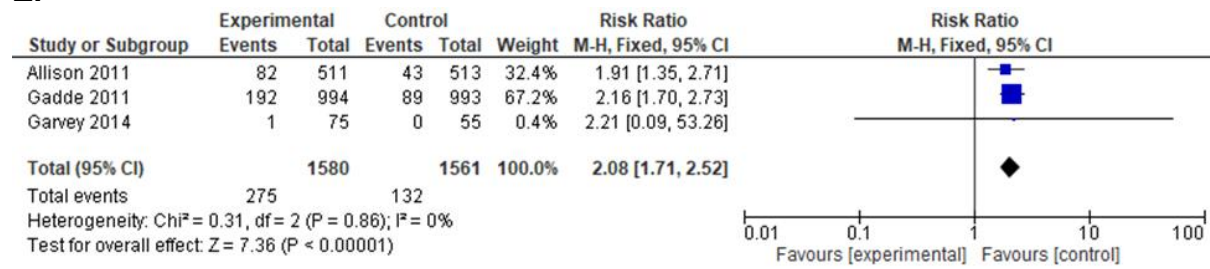
C.



D.

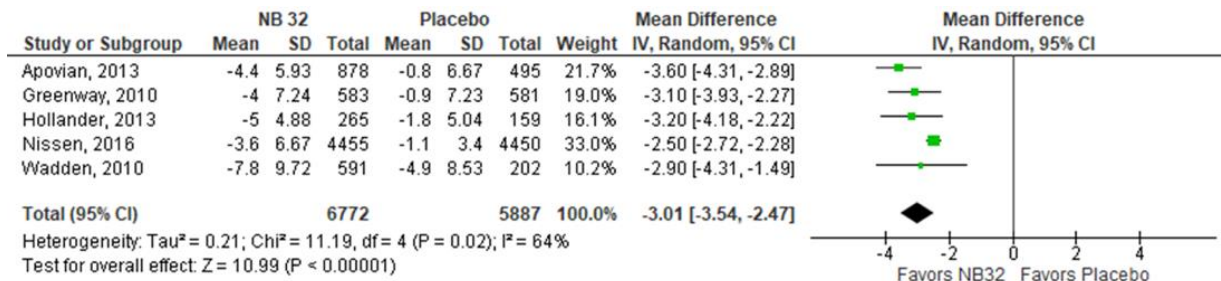


E.

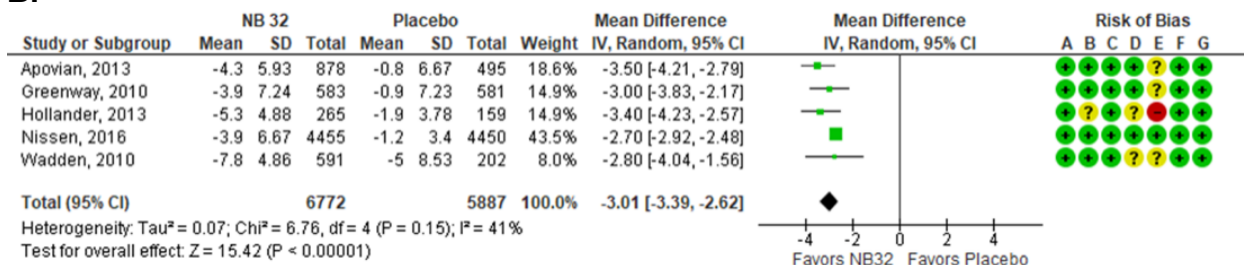


Supplementary Figure 6. Benefits and harms of naltrexone-bupropion ER over placebo in the management of obesity: **(A)** Mean difference in % total body weight loss; **(B)** Mean difference in weight loss (in kg); **(C)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 5% total body weight loss; **(D)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 10% total body weight loss; **(E)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 15% total body weight loss; **(F)** Serious adverse events; **(G)** Discontinuation of treatment due to adverse events

A.



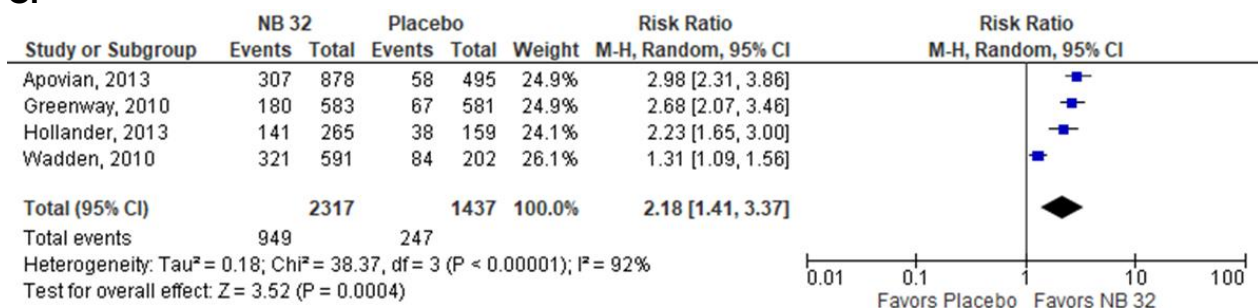
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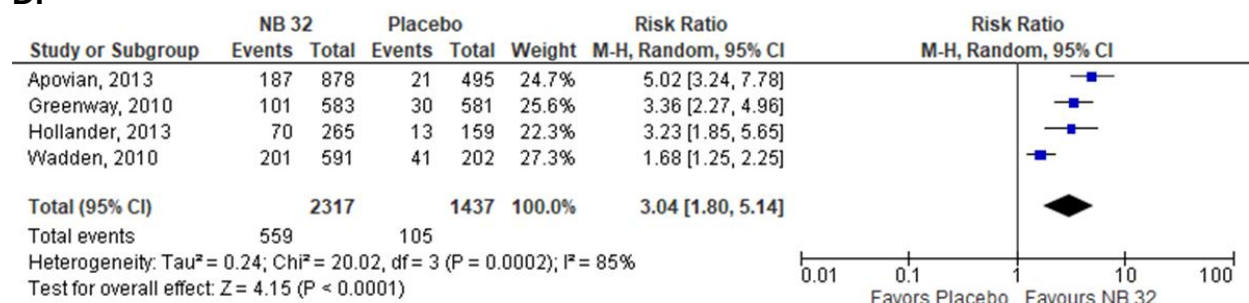
Risk of bias legend

- (A) Random sequence generation (selection bias)
- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

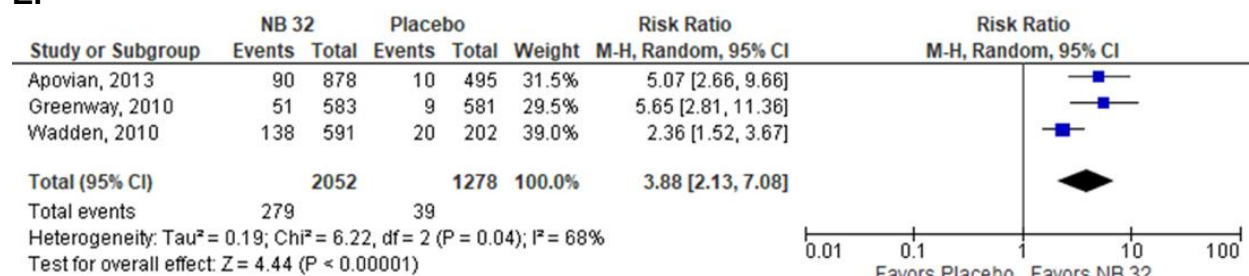
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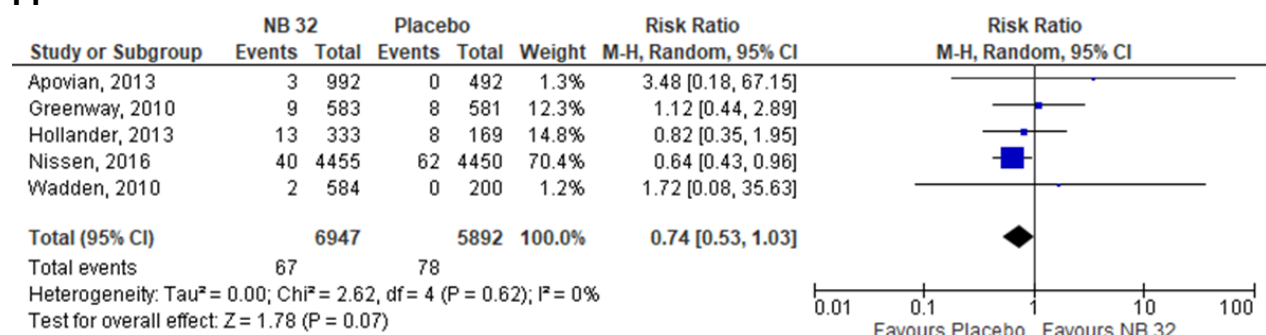
D.



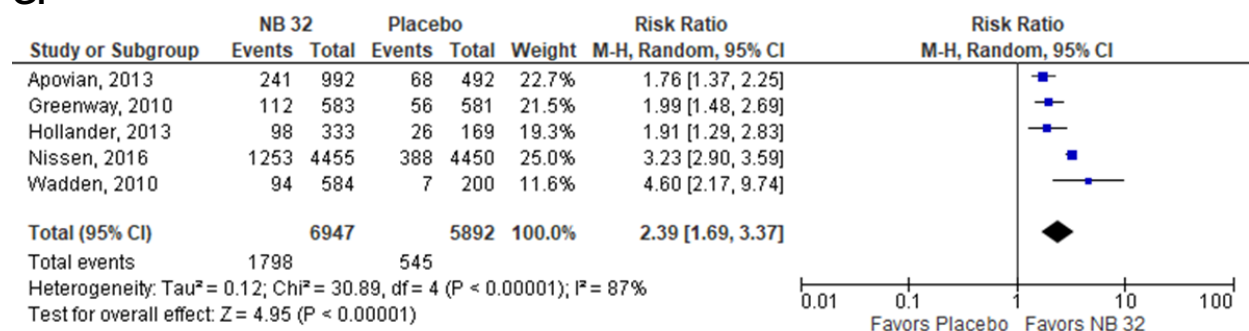
E.



F.

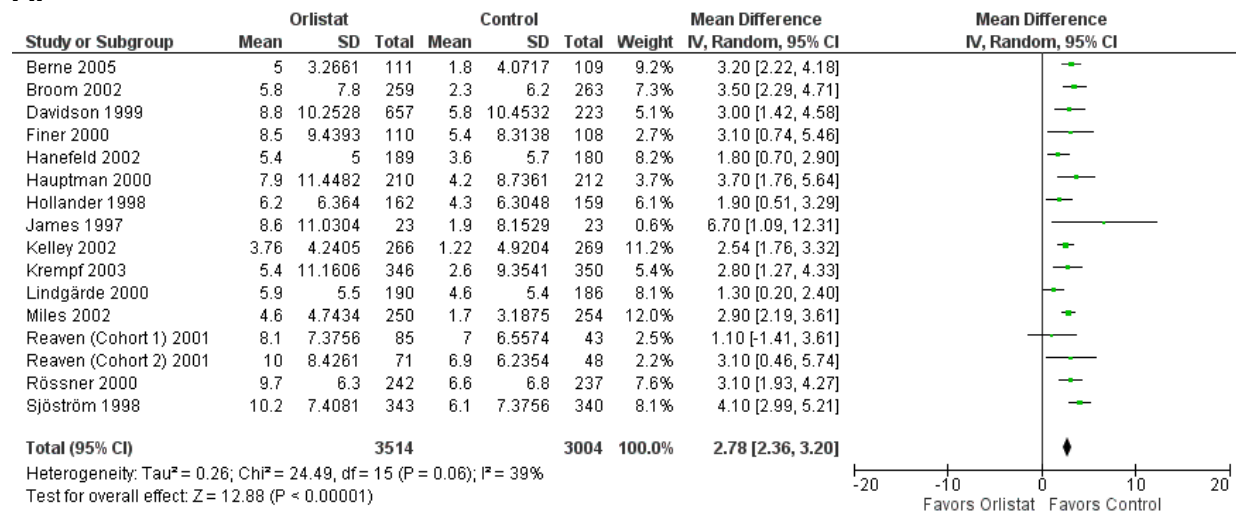


G.

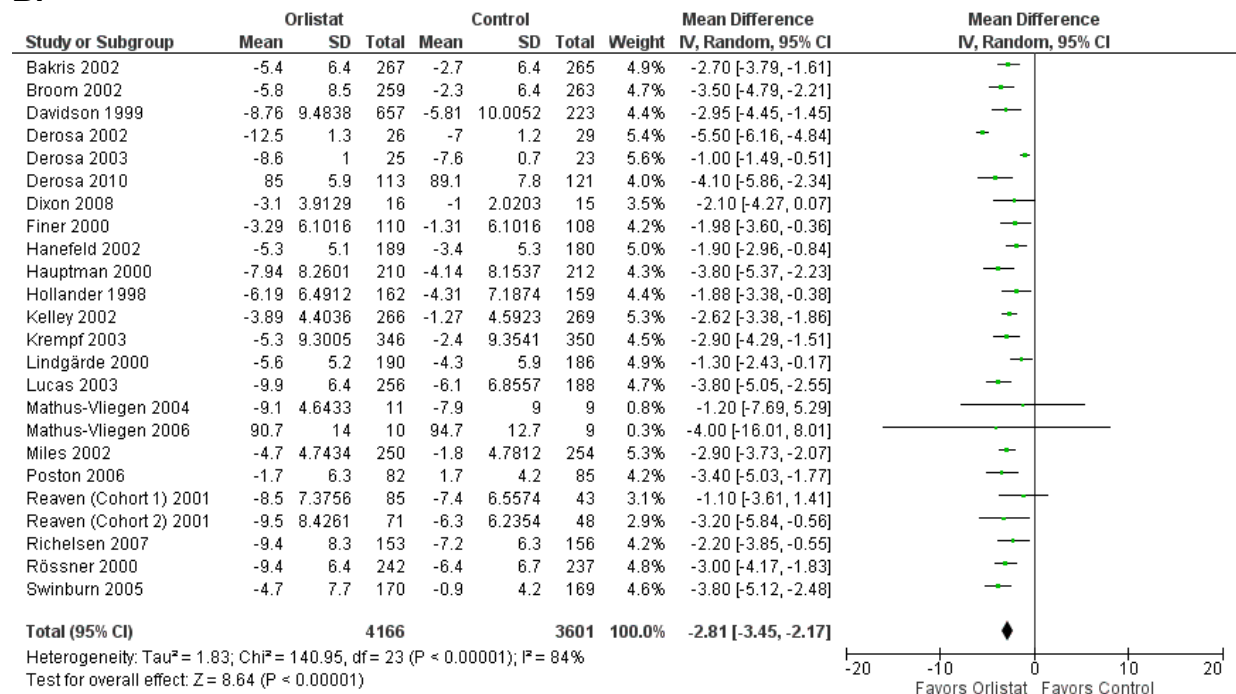


Supplementary Figure 7. Benefits and harms of orlistat over placebo in the management of obesity: (A) Mean difference in % total body weight loss; (B) Mean difference in weight loss (in kg); (C) Proportion of patients achieving at least 5% total body weight loss; (D) Proportion of patients achieving at least 10% total body weight loss; (E) Serious adverse events; (F) Discontinuation of treatment due to adverse events

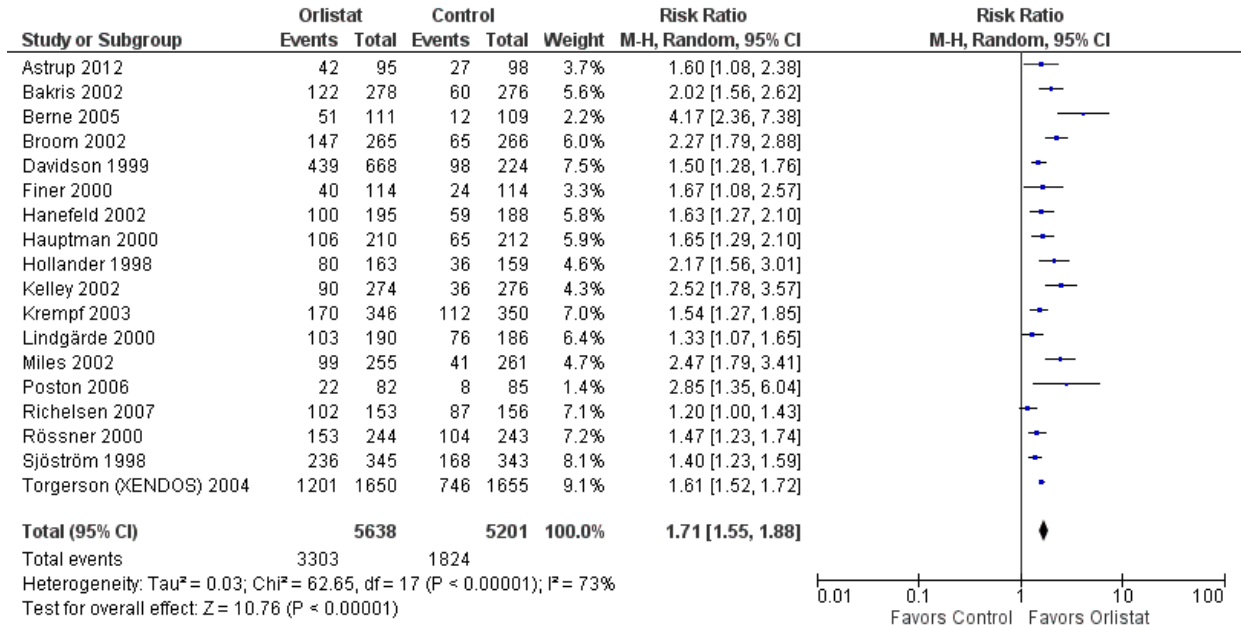
A.



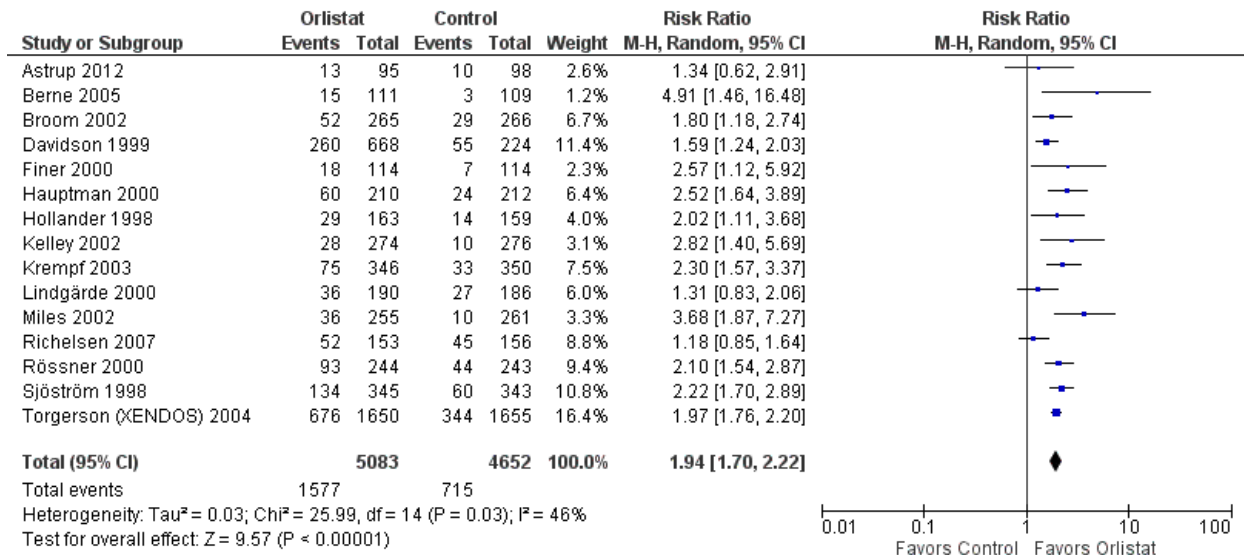
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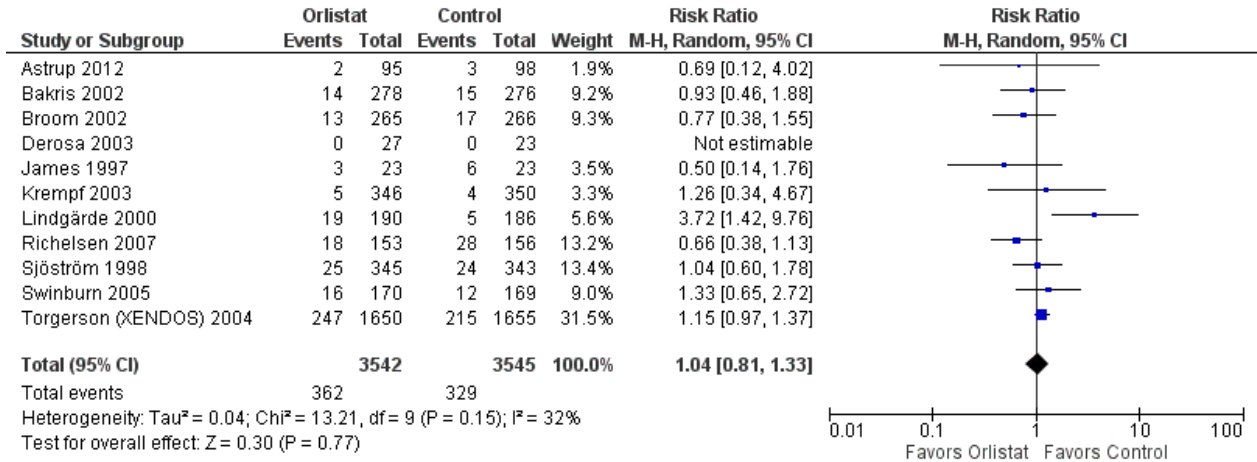
C.



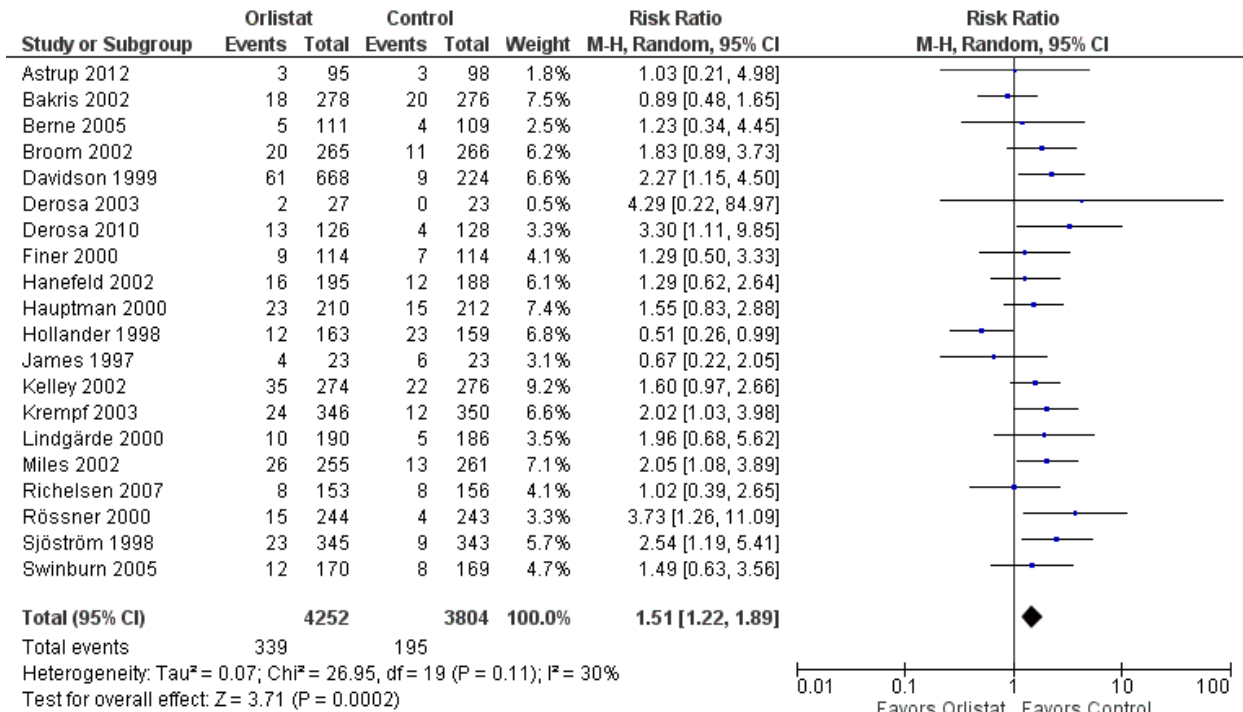
D.



E.

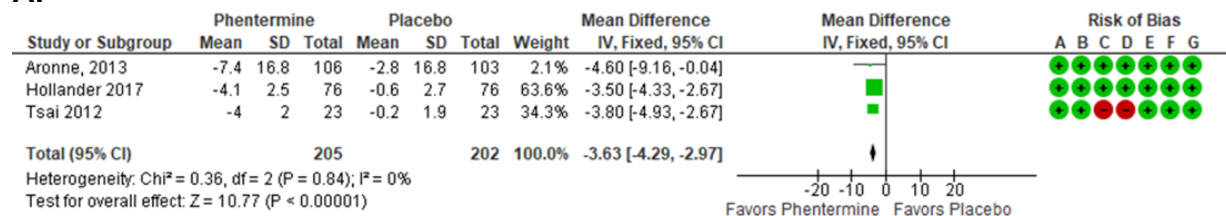


F.

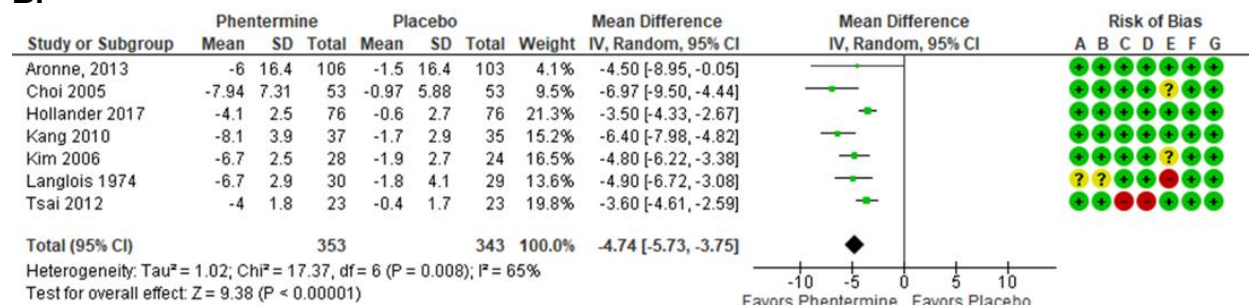


Supplementary Figure 8. Benefits and harms of phentermine over placebo in the management of obesity: **(A)** Mean difference in % total body weight loss; **(B)** Mean difference in weight loss (in kg); **(C)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 5% total body weight loss; **(D)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 10% total body weight loss; **(E)** Serious adverse events; **(F)** Discontinuation of treatment due to adverse events

A.



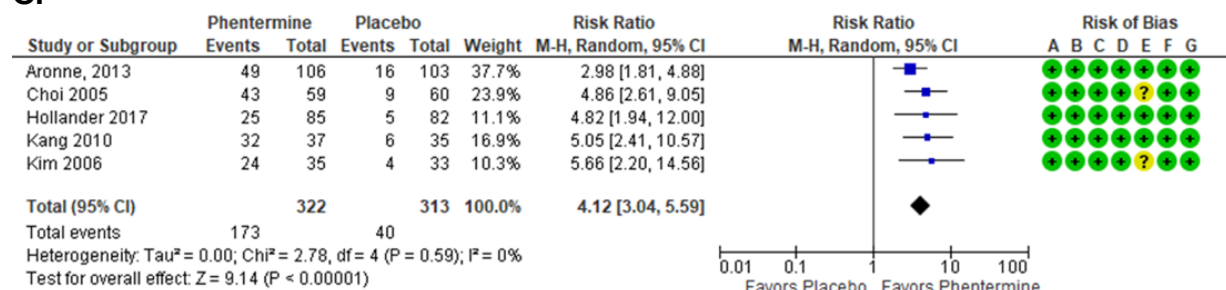
B.



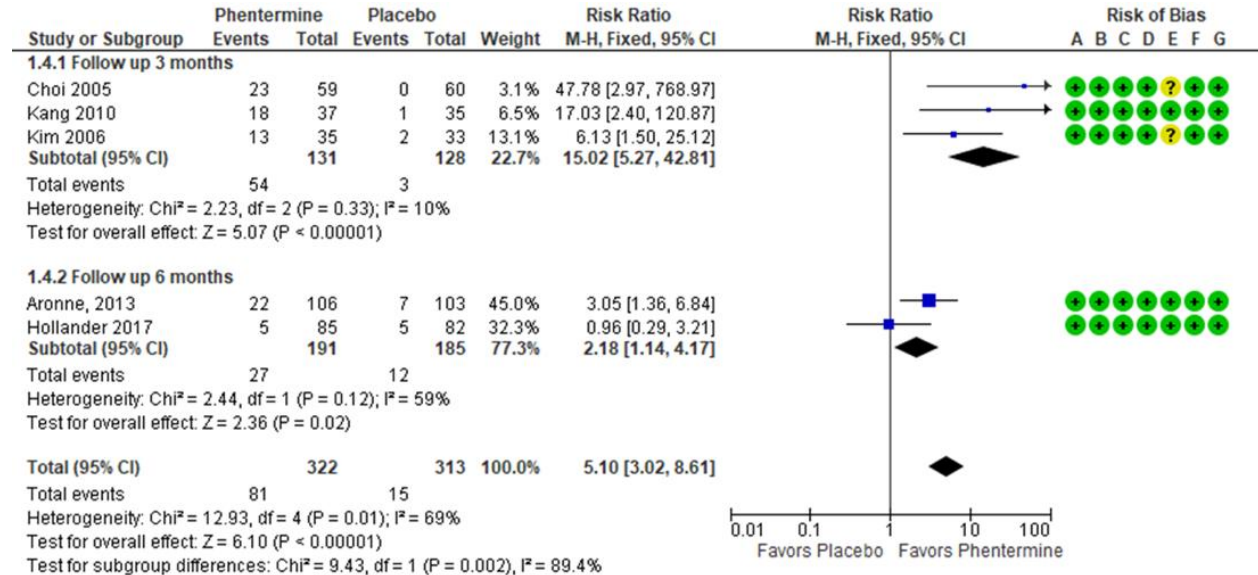
Risk of bias legend

- (A) Random sequence generation (selection bias)
- (B) Allocation concealment (selection bias)
- (C) Blinding of participants and personnel (performance bias)
- (D) Blinding of outcome assessment (detection bias)
- (E) Incomplete outcome data (attrition bias)
- (F) Selective reporting (reporting bias)
- (G) Other bias

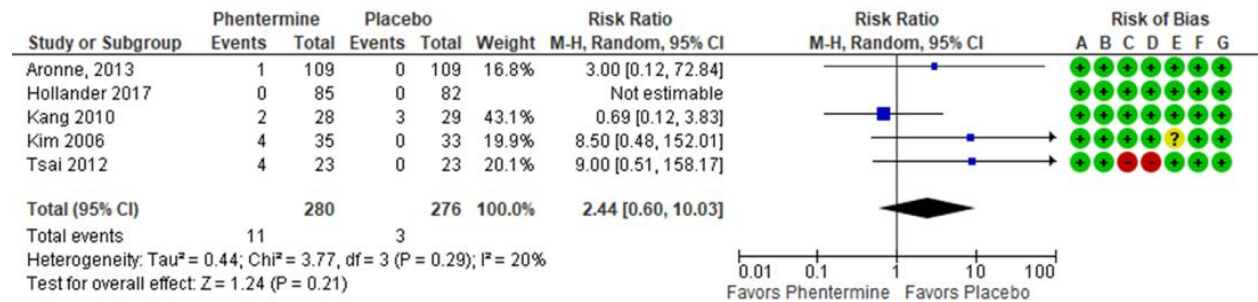
C.



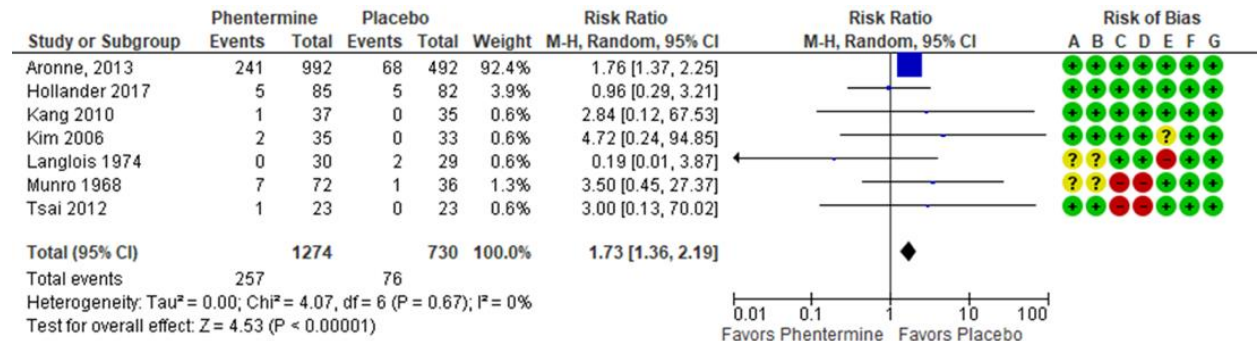
D.



E.

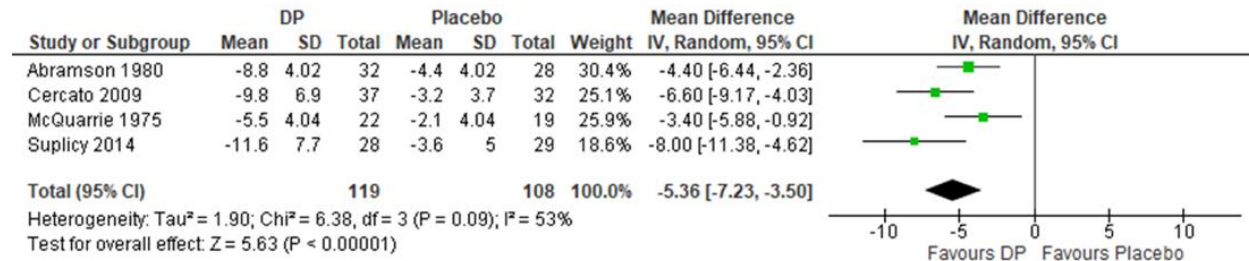


F.

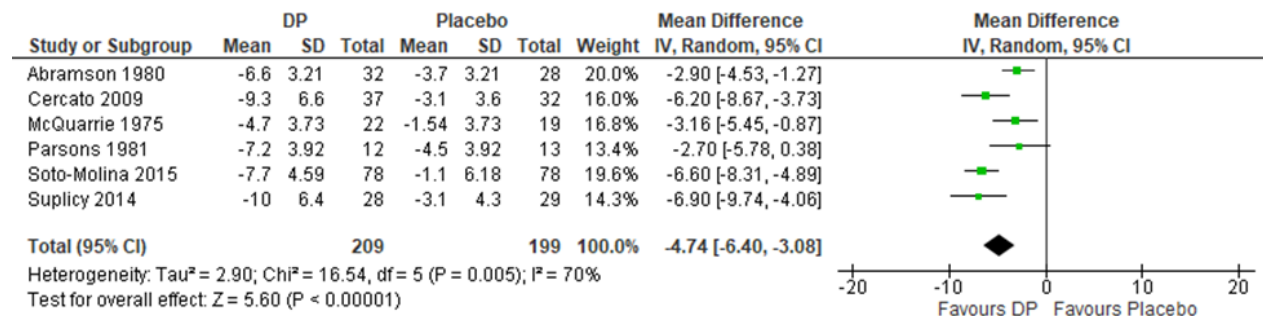


Supplementary Figure 9. Benefits and harms of diethylpropion over placebo in the management of obesity: **(A)** Mean difference in % total body weight loss; **(B)** Mean difference in weight loss (in kg); **(C)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 5% total body weight loss; **(D)** Proportion of patients achieving at least 10% total body weight loss; **(E)** Discontinuation of treatment due to adverse events

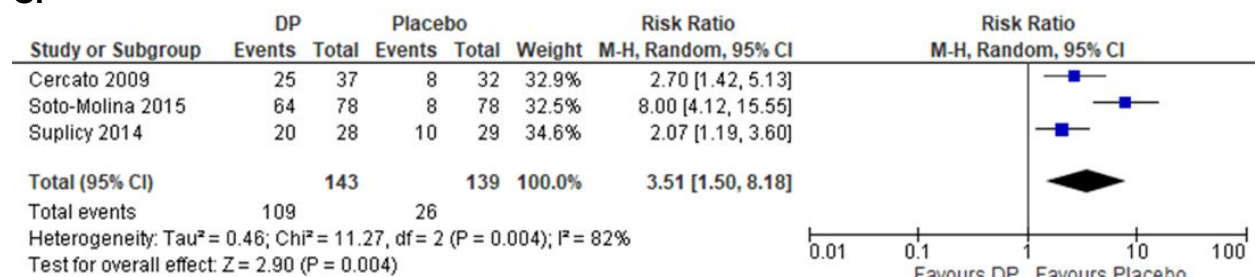
A.



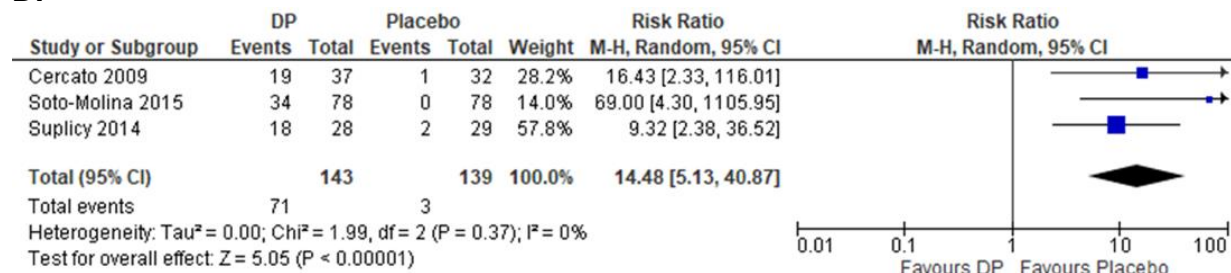
B.



C.



D.



E.

